MAKEHAPPN

How We Work

Business Functions · Products · Project Workflow · Dashboard Requirements

Purpose of this document: explain MakeHappn's operating model in practical terms so the dashboard developer can understand how work enters the studio, how it is sold and delivered, who is involved, what information moves between stages, and what the dashboard needs to track.

1. The MakeHappn Operating Model

MakeHappn is a multidisciplinary creative studio that connects ideas with the people who bring them to life. We work with clients to understand a need or opportunity, shape it into a clear creative and commercial scope, then bring together the right internal team, external makers, and trusted partners to deliver it.

We do not operate as separate departments handing work over in isolation. The functions work together around a client brief and a project owner. A project may involve only one service, such as brand identity, or combine several services into a complete turnkey experience.

The basic flow

1. Find the opportunity	2. Shape the work	3. Deliver the work	4. Close and learn
Client inquiry	Understand brief and define scope	Creative, design, planning and production	Final delivery, finances and review

The dashboard should make this flow visible. At any point, management should be able to see what the opportunity is, whether it has been converted into a project, what stage the project is in, who owns the next action, and whether the project is commercially healthy.

2. How the Business Functions Work Together

The functions below describe areas of responsibility, not necessarily separate departments. One person may own more than one function, and several functions may contribute to the same project.

Function	What this function does	When it is involved / what it hands over
Curation & Creative	Interprets the brief, researches the audience and context, develops ideas, shapes the concept and defines the creative direction.	Usually begins during discovery and proposal development, then provides the approved concept and creative framework to design and delivery.
Design	Turns the approved idea into visual, spatial, brand and technical outputs that can be reviewed, approved and produced.	Develops the concept into designs and specifications. Hands approved artwork, layouts, renders and technical information to production or the client.
Brand Communication	Defines how a brand or experience communicates through messaging, storytelling, content and campaigns.	May run as a standalone product or alongside brand design and experiences. Hands over approved messaging and communication assets.

Production & Procurement	Finds and coordinates suppliers, gathers quotations, checks feasibility, prepares cost information, manages fabrication and purchasing.	Becomes active during planning and pre-production. Hands over supplier confirmations, production status, quality checks and completed physical outputs.
Project Management & Operations	Owns the project plan, coordinates people and workstreams, tracks deadlines, manages dependencies, approvals, risks and delivery.	Coordinates the project from confirmation to close. Keeps the plan current and makes sure each next stage has what it needs.
Marketing & Communications	Builds MakeHappn's own visibility, communicates its offering, develops the portfolio and supports lead generation.	Runs continuously at company level and uses completed project material, case studies and insights to strengthen future sales.
Finance & legal	Tracks project budgets, costs, revenue, invoices, payment milestones, expenses and profitability.	Supports proposal costing and project controls, then tracks actual financial performance through final payment and closure.

3. What MakeHappn Sells: Products & Services

A product is the service or group of services the client is buying. A project is the specific piece of work being delivered for that client. One project can contain one product or a combination of products. The dashboard must therefore allow multiple products to be attached to a single project.

Curation

We shape the idea and the content of an experience. This can include research, audience understanding, concept development, programming, talent selection and partner sourcing.

Typical outputs: concept note, experience narrative, programme, curated talent or partner list.

Design

We translate a brief or concept into a visual, spatial or technical solution. This may include creative direction, graphic design, spatial design, 2D/3D development and technical layouts.

Typical outputs: moodboards, design routes, layouts, 3D renders, artwork and technical drawings.

Brand Design

We build or develop the visual identity and design system of a brand, making it recognisable and consistent across touchpoints.

Typical outputs: brand strategy inputs, identity, logo system, typography and colour system, brand guidelines and applications.

Brand Communication

We define how a brand speaks and connects with its audience through messaging, storytelling, content and campaign ideas.

Typical outputs: messaging framework, tone of voice, content direction, campaign concepts and communication assets.

Production

We turn approved designs and plans into physical outputs through sourcing, procurement, fabrication, printing, manufacturing, installation and quality control.

Typical outputs: supplier quotations, production schedule, samples, fabricated items, installed branding and completed setups.

Turnkey Experience

We take responsibility for bringing an experience together from the initial brief and creative direction through design, partners, production, on-ground delivery and close-out.

Typical outputs: integrated scope, experience concept, design package, production plan, live delivery and final report.

4. The End-to-End Project Workflow

The workflow below is the standard path from a new opportunity to a completed project. It should be configurable: a small brand design job may skip event production, while a turnkey experience may use every stage and several parallel workstreams.

Stage	What happens	Expected output	Control / status
01 · Lead / Inquiry	A potential client, existing client or referral presents an opportunity. Sales records who the client is, what they need, the source of the lead, the expected timing and the next follow-up.	Lead created; lead owner assigned; next action and follow-up date recorded.	Lead status: New → Contacted → Qualified / Not proceeding.
02 · Qualification & Discovery	The team checks whether the opportunity is right for MakeHappn and gathers enough information to understand the challenge. This may involve a call, meeting, site visit or written brief. Clarify objectives, audience, deliverables, budget range, timing, location and decision-makers.	Discovery notes and a usable client brief. Missing information and assumptions are visible.	A qualified lead moves to proposal. An unsuitable or inactive lead is marked accordingly.
03 · Scope, Proposal & Quotation	The team decides which MakeHappn products are relevant and defines what is included and excluded. Creative, design and production input may be needed to estimate effort, suppliers, costs and timing. Finance checks the commercial model and margin.	Proposal, scope of work, deliverables, timeline, assumptions, quotation and payment terms.	Proposal status: Draft → Internal review → Sent → Under discussion → Won / Lost / On hold.
04 · Project Confirmation & Handover	Once the client approves, the opportunity becomes an active project. The team records the approved scope, value, payment terms, key dates and project owner. Sales transfers the client context and commitments to the delivery team.	Confirmed project record, approved scope, contract or written approval, initial payment milestone and internal handover.	Do not treat an unapproved proposal as an active delivery project. Record confirmation before opening delivery tasks.
05 · Kick-off & Project Planning	The project owner turns the approved scope into a delivery plan. The team identifies workstreams, assigns owners, creates tasks and milestones, confirms dependencies, sets review dates and identifies risks.	Project plan, task list, owners, timeline, milestones, communication rhythm and risk list.	Project status: Planning / In progress. Each task has one accountable owner and a due date.
06 · Creative Development	The creative team interprets the approved brief and develops the concept or creative direction. The project owner coordinates feedback and ensures the work remains within the agreed scope.	Concept presentation, experience direction, creative rationale and client approval.	Approval gate: concept is approved, or feedback is captured and another revision round is assigned.

07 · Design Development	Designers develop the approved direction into the required visual, spatial, brand and technical materials. The project owner manages reviews and consolidates feedback so the team is not working from conflicting instructions.	Approved design files, layouts, renders, artwork, specifications and production-ready information.	Approval gate: designs are approved for production or delivery. Changes after approval may affect cost and timeline.
08 · Planning & Pre-Production	The team checks feasibility and prepares the work for execution. Production gathers supplier quotations, compares options, confirms availability, updates the cost sheet, prepares schedules and secures required approvals.	Locked or approved cost sheet, supplier and partner confirmations, production schedule, procurement plan and quality checklist.	Production should proceed only when the required designs, budget and client approvals are confirmed.
09 · Production & Execution	The team manages making, purchasing, fabrication, printing, logistics, installation and coordination. The project owner tracks progress against the production plan, resolves issues and records changes.	Completed items, progress updates, quality checks, installation readiness and updated actual costs.	Issues are logged with an owner, impact, decision and resolution. Scope or budget changes require approval.
10 · Delivery / Live Operations	The team delivers the final output or manages the live experience. This may include setup, event-day operations, client walkthrough, handover, troubleshooting and final quality checks.	Delivered project, client handover or event completion, documentation and outstanding-item list.	Record completion, incidents, client feedback and any remaining actions.
11 · Financial & Project Close	The team reconciles the final scope and costs, follows up on outstanding client payments, closes supplier payments, organises project files and reviews performance.	Final cost and revenue, actual profit, payment status, final documentation and project review.	Project can be marked Closed when delivery, documentation and financial close-out requirements are satisfied.

5. How Work Moves Between People

The project owner is the connecting point across the workflow. The owner does not need to complete every task, but is responsible for making sure the right person has the right information at the right time.

1. Sales captures the opportunity and records the client's needs, timing and commercial context.
2. The relevant creative, design and production people contribute to defining the scope and estimating the work.
3. After approval, the project owner runs an internal handover so the delivery team understands exactly what was sold.
4. The project owner breaks the scope into workstreams, tasks, owners, deadlines and approval points.
5. Creative and design teams develop the work; client feedback is consolidated and recorded against the relevant deliverable.
6. Once designs and costs are approved, production coordinates external makers and partners to execute the work.
7. The project owner coordinates delivery, confirms completion and ensures the final financial and documentation steps are closed.

Important: the dashboard should not rely on informal messages as the only record of decisions. Key approvals, scope changes, budget changes and delivery decisions should be recorded against the project.

6. Parallel Workstreams & Dependencies

Not all project work happens in a single straight line. Some activities can run in parallel, but certain activities depend on earlier approvals or information.

Workstream	Can run alongside	Must be ready before
Creative development	Early supplier research, venue research and preliminary feasibility checks.	Approved brief and agreed creative scope.
Design development	Planning, early cost checks and production feasibility discussions.	Approved creative direction.
Production planning	Supplier discovery, availability checks and preliminary costing can start earlier.	Final enough design information and confirmed scope to lock costs.
Procurement / fabrication	Some long-lead sourcing can be prepared in advance.	Required client approvals, approved cost and production-ready specifications.
Marketing / content	Campaign planning and content preparation can run alongside design and production.	Approved messaging, brand assets and confirmed campaign information.
Event / delivery preparation	Staffing, logistics, run-of-show and operational planning.	Confirmed scope, schedule, venue and key supplier commitments.

Dashboard implication: support dependencies between tasks and milestones, but allow the project owner to customise the workflow for each project rather than forcing every project through an identical checklist.

7. Project Changes, Feedback & Approvals

Client feedback and changes are normal parts of creative work. The system should distinguish between feedback within the agreed scope and a change that affects the scope, budget or timeline.

- Feedback: comments or requested refinements to a deliverable that remain within the agreed scope.
- Revision: a defined round of updates to a concept, design or deliverable.
- Scope change: a new requirement, additional deliverable or significant direction change beyond the approved scope.
- Approval: a recorded client or internal decision allowing the next stage to proceed.
- Change request: a documented change showing what changed, why, who approved it, and its impact on cost and timing.

Recommended rule: no material scope, cost or timeline change should be treated as approved until the decision and its impact are recorded. The dashboard should keep a history of versions, approvals and changes.

8. MakeHappn Collective: External Talent & Partners

MakeHappn works with an extended circle of external people and businesses. These relationships should be stored centrally and linked to the projects where they contribute.

Group	Who belongs here	How they are used
Collective Makers	Individual creatives and specialists such as artists, designers, photographers, craftspeople and fabricators.	Selected for creative input, specialist skills or making specific project outputs.

Collective Partners	Businesses and organisations such as venues, suppliers, F&B providers, hospitality, entertainment and service companies.	Engaged to provide services, spaces, products, logistics or other project support.

A Collective record should include contact details, category, specialism or service, location, relationship owner, past projects, notes and relationship status. A project should be able to link multiple makers and partners, with the role and agreed cost or fee recorded for each engagement.

9. Financial Flow: From Estimate to Actual

Financial information begins during proposal preparation and is updated throughout delivery. The dashboard should make it possible to compare what MakeHappn expected to earn and spend with what actually happened.

Moment	What is recorded
Proposal stage	Quoted client value, estimated internal effort, estimated external costs, contingency, expected gross profit and payment terms.
Project confirmation	Approved project value, agreed payment milestones, deposit status and approved budget.
During delivery	Committed supplier costs, purchase orders or confirmations, actual expenses, variations and additional client approvals.
Project close	Final invoiced revenue, collected payments, final supplier and project costs, outstanding balances and actual project profit.

The dashboard should clearly distinguish estimated, committed and actual costs. These are different figures and should not be combined into one number.

10. Dashboard Modules & What Each Must Connect

Module	Core information and connections
Overview	Company-level KPIs, sales pipeline, active projects, upcoming deadlines, overdue tasks, cash/payment alerts and team workload.
Sales	Leads, contacts, client history, opportunity value, lead owner, next follow-up, proposals and conversion status.
Projects	Project record, client, selected products, owner, stage, status, scope, milestones, dates, files and linked financials.
Tasks & Team	Tasks, accountable owner, collaborators, priority, deadline, status, dependencies, comments and workload.
Creative & Design	Briefs, concepts, design deliverables, file versions, review rounds and approval history.
Production & Procurement	Supplier quotes, selected suppliers, purchase commitments, production tasks, schedules, delivery status and quality checks.
Collective / Resources	Internal team, Makers, Partners, capabilities, contacts, relationship status and project history.
Finance	Quoted value, approved budget, estimated / committed / actual costs, invoices, payments, expenses and profitability.
Reports	Sales by product, client and period; project margin; estimate versus actual; delivery performance; team capacity and pipeline health.

11. Recommended Status Logic

Record type	Suggested statuses
Lead	New · Contacted · Qualified · Proposal in progress · Won · Lost · On hold
Proposal	Draft · Internal review · Sent · Under discussion · Approved · Declined · Expired
Project	Not started · Planning · In progress · Waiting for client · At risk · On hold · Delivered · Closed
Task	To do · In progress · Waiting · In review · Approved · Done · Blocked
Deliverable	Draft · Internal review · Sent to client · Revision required · Approved · Final
Payment	Not invoiced · Invoiced · Partially paid · Paid · Overdue

Statuses should be consistent across the dashboard, with clear definitions. For example, 'Delivered' means the work has been handed over or the experience has taken place; 'Closed' means the project's required financial and administrative close-out is also complete.

12. Core Project Record: Required Fields

- Project name, unique project code and project type

- Client, main contact and lead source
- Project owner and assigned internal team
- Products selected and detailed scope
- Brief, objectives, audience, location and key requirements
- Quoted value, approved value and payment terms
- Estimated, committed and actual costs
- Expected and actual profitability
- Start date, key milestones and delivery date
- Current stage, project status and overall health
- Tasks, task owners, deadlines and dependencies
- Deliverables, versions, reviews and approvals
- Linked Collective Makers, Partners and suppliers
- Invoices, payments, expenses and outstanding balances
- Risks, issues, change requests and decisions
- Final files, photographs, client feedback and close-out report

13. What Management Needs to See

View	Questions it should answer
Business view	How much business is in the pipeline? What has been won? What revenue is expected? Which products and clients generate business?
Project view	What stage is each project in? What is due next? Which projects are delayed, waiting for approval or at risk? Are projects within budget?
Team view	Who owns each project and task? What is overdue? Where is the workload concentrated? Who is blocked or waiting for input?
Financial view	What has been quoted, approved, committed, spent, invoiced and collected? What is the expected and actual project profit?

14. Guiding Principles for the Developer

- Projects are the central record that connects clients, products, people, tasks, files, partners, approvals and financials.
- A project can include multiple products and multiple workstreams.
- Each project and task must have a clear owner; shared responsibility should not mean unclear accountability.
- Every stage should show its status, owner, due date, required inputs and expected output.

- Approvals and change requests should be recorded with dates and decision history.
- Estimated, committed and actual costs must remain distinct.
- Templates should speed up setup, but project owners must be able to adapt stages and tasks to the project scope.
- The dashboard should show exceptions that need attention, not just store information.

The goal

Build one connected operating system for MakeHappn: a system that follows an opportunity from first contact to a confirmed project, guides the team through creative and operational delivery, connects the right people and partners, and gives management a reliable view of performance and profitability.